



# English Advanced

## Paper 1 – Texts and Human Experiences

### Stimulus Booklet for Section I *and* List of prescribed texts for Section II

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## Section I

### Text 1 – Image



THOMAS STRUTH

Art Institute of Chicago II, Chicago, 1990  
Chromogenic print mounted to acrylic  
Edition Number Three of Ten  
184.1 x 219 cm, framed  
Reproduced with permission

## Text 2 – Nonfiction extract

### Against Honeymoons

My sense is that a lot of people actually have a hard time travelling for leisure. There are some people, of course, who fail to really “get away” because they can’t leave something behind. The classic image would be the honeymooner apologizing as she ducks into a room to take another call from work. When she isn’t on the phone you can catch her staring into space.

Solutions to being elsewhere are, it seems to me, pretty straightforward under most circumstances. Shut off the phone. Then time is on your side. My distraction, by contrast, was a bit more insidious. It seemed to feed on the objectively good experiences of the trip itself. It wasn’t that I couldn’t see my perfect macadamia-crusted mahi-mahi very clearly. But it was like I aimed my fork at the fish but kept accidentally skewering something else – my future reminiscence of it. I wasn’t elsewhere, but I seemed to inhabit a time other than the present. I wanted to be, as we say, “present”. But my problem with presence seemed to be capable of feeding my own awareness of it. “Just relax”, I would tell myself. “Well, I can’t relax when I’m anxious about relaxing”, I would (accurately) reflect, and so forth as new and seemingly more nuanced forms of self-correction recommended themselves seductively as a solution to the problem they were creating.

CHARLES COMEY

Extract from ‘Against Honeymoons’

*The Point Magazine, Examined Life (Issue 10), 2015*

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### **Text 3 – Poem**

#### **Tissue**

Paper that lets the light  
shine through, this  
is what could alter things.  
Paper thinned by age or touching,

the kind you find in well-used books,  
the back of the Koran, where a hand  
has written in the names and histories,  
who was born to whom,

the height and weight, who  
died where and how, on which sepia date,  
pages smoothed and stroked and turned  
transparent with attention.

If buildings were paper, I might  
feel their drift, see how easily  
they fall away on a sigh, a shift  
in the direction of the wind.

Maps too. The sun shines through  
their borderlines, the marks  
that rivers make, roads,  
railtracks, mountainfolds,

Fine slips from grocery shops  
that say how much was sold  
and what was paid by credit card  
might fly our loves like paper kites.

An architect could use all this,  
place layer over layer, luminous  
script over numbers over line,  
and never wish to build again with brick

**Text 3 continues on page 5**

Text 3 (continued)

or block, but let the daylight break  
through capitals and monoliths,  
through the shapes that pride can make,  
find a way to trace a grand design

with living tissue, raise a structure  
never meant to last,  
of paper smoothed and stroked  
and thinned to be transparent,

turned into your skin.

IMITAZ DHAKEER

In *The terrorist at my table*, 2006  
Bloodaxe Books  
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**End of Text 3**

#### Text 4 – Biography extract

##### BLAINVILLE

All sorts of unsuccessful tries marked by indecision.

Smiling photographs of Duchamp are rare. His characteristic expression, in snapshots as well as informal portraits, is rather somber – not self-conscious but guarded, watchful, unsurprised. A certain gravity must have been part of his nature even as a child, but this was not the part that most people noticed or remembered. What struck close friends and distant admirers alike was how easily he moved through the world. All his life Duchamp travelled light, carrying only enough baggage to sustain basic needs.

In later years, when it was commonly believed that he no longer made art, he told me that he was simply a “*respirateur*,” a “breather,” implying that this was occupation enough for anyone. The French expression *bien dans sa peau* – at home in his skin – fitted him perfectly, in the second half of his life, at any rate, after he had put *The Large Glass* behind him and embarked on his career as a chess player. It was as though the freedom that he had finally achieved in art carried over into his life, so that he could be free of art, too. Interviewers (and there were more and more of these during his last decade, when fame overtook him for the second time) marveled at how easy it was to talk with Duchamp. He replied to their questions in a relaxed, witty, highly quotable style, he never made anyone feel unintelligent, and as a result reporters rarely wrote unkind pieces about him. It was seductive, this lightness of spirit, but it also served to keep others from getting too close. The corollary to lightness was detachment. He put a high value on what he called the “beauty of indifference.”

Duchamp rarely talked about his childhood. When he did, he gave the impression that it had been a happy one, with little conflict and much shared affection, but he also made it clear that this affection did not extend to his mother. Lucie Nicolle suffered from a progressive hearing disorder that had made her almost completely deaf by the time Marcel [Duchamp] was born, and she dealt with this by withdrawing more and more into a private world of her own. Duchamp described her as “placid and indifferent.” He must have learned at an early age to internalize his feelings about her – indifference, after all, would become one of his guiding principles. Duchamp once said that he had “intensely disliked” his mother and that his two older brothers had felt the same way about her. For someone as reticent as Duchamp on the subject of personal relationships, this was a startling admission. He said virtually nothing else about her, though, and Lucie Duchamp, who left no diaries or memoirs, remains a mysterious and silent figure on the fringes of that happy childhood.

Text 4 continues on page 7

#### Text 4 (continued)

For the first two years of his life, Marcel [Duchamp] was virtually an only child, both his older brothers having gone away to school in Rouen the year before he was born. If his mother was distant and withdrawn, he nevertheless found a warm ally in Clemence Lebourg, the sweet-tempered country woman who had come to work for the Duchamp family when they moved to her native village of Cany-Barville and who remained with them until Lucie and Eugene died, within a week of each other, in 1925. (A few months after they died, the inconsolable Clemence drowned herself in the Seine.) Marcel “adored” his brothers, who came home for occasional weekend visits in addition to their school vacations, and he often spoke of feeling love and admiration for his father. The family member he was closest to throughout their childhood, however, was his sister Suzanne, born two years after him in the fall of 1889. The two of them were natural allies. Suzanne, a tomboy with a boisterous sense of fun, became a willing accomplice in the games and activities that her brother’s fertile imagination provided for them. Later, when their mother began to devote her attention almost exclusively to the two youngest children, Yvonne and Magdeleine (born in 1895 and 1898), Marcel and Suzanne drew even closer together.

CALVIN TOMKINS

Extract from *Duchamp: A Biography*, 2014  
The Wiley Agency (UK) Ltd.  
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**End of Text 4**

## Section II

The prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
  - Anthony Doerr, *All the Light We Cannot See*
  - Amanda Lohrey, *Vertigo*
  - George Orwell, *Nineteen Eighty-Four*
  - Favel Parrett, *Past the Shallows*
- **Poetry**
  - Rosemary Dobson, *Rosemary Dobson Collected*
    - The prescribed poems are:
      - \* *Young Girl at a Window*
      - \* *Over the Hill*
      - \* *Summer's End*
      - \* *The Conversation*
      - \* *Cock Crow*
      - \* *Amy Caroline*
      - \* *Canberra Morning*
  - Kenneth Slessor, *Selected Poems*
    - The prescribed poems are:
      - \* *Wild Grapes*
      - \* *Gulliver*
      - \* *Out of Time*
      - \* *Vesper-Song of the Reverend Samuel Marsden*
      - \* *William Street*
      - \* *Beach Burial*
- **Drama**
  - Jane Harrison, *Rainbow's End*, from Vivienne Cleven et al.,
  - *Contemporary Indigenous Plays*
  - Arthur Miller, *The Crucible*
- **Shakespearean Drama**
  - William Shakespeare, *The Merchant of Venice*

Section II continues on page 9



## Section II prescribed texts (continued)

- **Nonfiction**
  - Tim Winton, *The Boy Behind the Curtain*
    - The prescribed chapters are:
      - \* *Havoc: A Life in Accidents*
      - \* *Betsy*
      - \* *Twice on Sundays*
      - \* *The Wait and the Flow*
      - \* *In the Shadow of the Hospital*
      - \* *The Demon Shark*
      - \* *Barefoot in the Temple of Art*
  - Malala Yousafzai and Christina Lamb, *I am Malala*
- **Film**
  - Stephen Daldry, *Billy Elliot*
- **Media**
  - Ivan O'Mahoney, *Go Back to Where You Came From*
    - The prescribed episodes are:
      - \* *Series 1: Episodes 1, 2 and 3*
      - and
      - \* *The Response*
  - Lucy Walker, *Waste Land*

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**2021**

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**DO NOT REMOVE PAPER FROM EXAM ROOM**

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Student Number

# English Advanced

## Paper 1 – Texts and Human Experiences

Morning Session  
Monday, 26 July 2021

### General Instructions

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 1 hour and 30 minutes
- Write using black pen
- A Stimulus Booklet is provided with this examination

**Total marks – 40**

**Section I**

Page 2

**20 marks**

- Attempt Questions 1-5
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

**Section II**

Page 3

**20 marks**

- Attempt Question 6
- Allow about 45 minutes for this section

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## Section I

**20 marks**

**Attempt Questions 1 - 5**

**Allow about 45 minutes for this section**

Answer the questions in a SEPARATE writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

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In your answers you will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
  - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
- 

Read **Texts 1, 2, 3 and 4** in the Stimulus Booklet carefully and then answer the questions.

**Question 1** (3 marks)

Use **Text 1** to answer this question.

How does the experience of viewing art transport individuals to different worlds?

**Question 2** (3 marks)

Use **Text 1** to answer this question.

How do the ideas in this text challenge assumptions about new experiences?

**Question 3** (5 marks)

Use **Texts 1 and 2** to answer this question.

To what extent do Texts 1 and 2 suggest the paradox of the real and the imagined?

**Question 4** (4 marks)

Use **Text 3** to answer this question.

How is paper used in the poem *Tissue* as a metaphor for human fragility?

**Question 5** (5 marks)

Use **Text 4** to answer this question.

Discuss how Tomkins captures the ways Duchamp's character was impacted by family relationships.

**End of Section I**

## Section II

**20 marks**

**Attempt Question 6**

**Allow about 45 minutes for this section**

Answer the question in a SEPARATE writing booklet. Extra writing booklets are available.

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Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate understanding of human experiences in texts
  - analyse, explain and assess the ways human experiences are represented in texts
  - organise, develop and express ideas using language appropriate to audience, purpose and context
- 

### **Question 6 (20 marks)**

*Texts raise questions which provide insights into the human experience.*

To what extent has the composer of your prescribed text raised questions which provide insights into the human experience?

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**End of examination**

## EXAMINERS

Marilyn Pretorius (Convenor)  
Debbie Hanrahan  
Paul Horvath  
Helen McCarthy  
Kate O'Connor  
Rachel Palgan  
Georgina Tsiftis  
Deborah Quigley

SCEGGS, Darlinghurst  
Marist College Eastwood  
Snowy Mountains Grammar School, Jindabyne  
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